

The Best Advice I Ever Got

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Uber India is the local arm of the global ride-hailing giant



PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

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**‘A good leader
steps up when
the need arises’**

What was the problem that you were grappling with?

The onslaught of the pandemic and the strict restrictions that followed were very hard to grapple with. As a business that serves cities and communities, we had to navigate this once-in-a-lifetime storm of cities coming to a grinding halt, drivers unable to drive and earn a living, and each city battling a health and humanitarian crisis.

Who did you approach for advice and why?

As a business leader, I am surrounded by a team of super talented, passionate and often more experienced leaders. I always tap into their collective wisdom and experience—it is my secret ingredient.

What was the advice you received?

The advice was to be a good leader and lead by example. One must first learn to trust oneself and the process. In business, there will be unique challenges thrown at you every day. A good leader is someone who provides fresh perspectives, helps develop key skills, and steps up for his/her people and community when the need arises.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

I am incredibly proud of how our team turned the crisis [pandemic] into an opportunity to serve our cities and the communities. Taking a people-first approach, we launched Uber Medics for transporting healthcare workers. We also launched Uber Essential for critical travel during lockdowns and Uber Connect for package deliveries. We extended benefits worth ₹100 crore to driver partners to help them weather the impact of the pandemic. I strongly believe that experience is the best teacher. This is all the more relevant in a world of extreme volatility. **BT**

—ALOKESH BHATTACHARYYA

Vol. 31, No. 21 for the fortnight
October 3, 2022 to October 16, 2022.
Released on October 3, 2022.
Total number of pages 158 (including cover)